

Chinese Elm

Ulmus parvifolia



Origin

Native to China, Korea, Japan, and Vietnam; introduced to the US in the early 1900s and increasingly planted as a naturally disease-resistant substitute after American elm losses.

Look for

Its bark peels away in irregular patches of gray, green, orange, and brown, creating a mottled, camouflage-like pattern -- a completely different look from the deeply furrowed bark of American elm.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Bark: mottled patches of gray, green, orange, and brown -- puzzle-piece camouflage pattern.
- Leaf: small, glossy, toothed, smaller than American elm's.
- Fall: often holds leaves later into fall than other elms.
- Commonly confused with: Siberian elm (Chinese elm's bark is distinctly mottled and peeling, not gray and furrowed) and American elm (Chinese elm's leaves are much smaller).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Small, glossy toothed leaves emerge early.
Summer	Fine-textured, dense canopy of small leaves.
Fall	Leaves can turn yellow to reddish-purple, and it often holds leaves later than other elms.
Winter	Distinctive mottled, exfoliating bark is most visible on bare trunks.

DID YOU KNOW

- Unlike American elm, it's naturally resistant to Dutch elm disease, which is why it's become one of the most common elm replacements in cities.
- It's sometimes confused with Siberian elm, a less desirable, weaker-wooded species -- the puzzle-piece bark pattern is the easiest way to tell true Chinese elm apart.